

Ankit Raj

Senior Cloud Solution Architect — Azure AI, Infrastructure & Data Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Strategic Cloud Solution Architect with 8+ years driving Azure AI transformation and cloud adoption for enterprise customers. Led end-to-end technical delivery of production-scale AI platforms serving 200+ teams, architected Azure workloads using CAF and WAF frameworks, and accelerated Azure adoption by resolving technical blockers. Proven trusted advisor to IT executives and business leaders, delivering measurable business impact through architecture design sessions, repeatable IP development, and technical excellence across Azure AI Foundry, GitHub, App Services, Databricks, and Fabric.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Azure AI & Data	Azure AI Foundry, Azure Applications, App Services, Databricks, Fabric, Azure Data, Production-scale AI
Cloud Architecture	Azure Infrastructure, Azure workloads, Cloud Adoption Framework (CAF), Well-Architected Framework (WAF), Multi-cloud architecture
Development & DevOps	GitHub, CI/CD, Infrastructure as Code, Terraform, Azure Functions, API Gateway, Containerization
AI & Machine Learning	AI transformation, LLM orchestration, Multi-model inference, OpenAI, Bedrock, Vertex AI, GenAI applications
Enterprise & Governance	Technical delivery, Azure adoption, FinOps, Cloud governance, Security frameworks, Compliance controls

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Cloud Solution Architect — AI & Multi-Cloud 2024 — Present

H&M Group

- Built trusted relationships with IT executives and business leaders as strategic advisor for Cloud and AI transformation across 200+ product teams, translating business requirements into secure, scalable Azure solutions
- Led architecture design sessions for enterprise AI platforms on Azure AI Foundry, delivering end-to-end production-scale AI readiness with multi-model orchestration and automated scaling
- Drove technical excellence across Azure workloads through comprehensive governance framework implementation across 1600+ subscriptions, ensuring security and compliance controls
- Accelerated Azure adoption by establishing FinOps programme delivering 35% cost reduction through right-sizing, reserved capacity, and automated governance policies
- Owned technical delivery oversight for cloud migration strategy, enabling digital transformation across retail and supply chain Azure workloads
- Contributed to Microsoft's technical communities through mentoring 8+ engineers, knowledge sharing, and thought leadership in cloud architecture best practices

Lead Cloud Solution Architect — Financial Services 2025 — 2026

Ikano Bank

- Owned end-to-end technical delivery for AML & KYC cloud migration aligned to customer success plans, reducing latency by 70% through serverless architecture implementation
- Led architecture design sessions using CAF and WAF frameworks to guide delivery of secure, scalable, and resilient Azure solutions handling 500K+ daily financial transactions
- Accelerated Azure adoption by developing repeatable IP — LLM-powered autonomous migration agent reducing delivery time by 60% and resolving technical blockers
- Delivered impactful delivery proposals to executive stakeholders showcasing serverless performance improvements, driving consensus for full Azure adoption
- Drive technical excellence through GitHub Actions CI/CD implementation, increasing deployment frequency 10x and establishing DevOps best practices

Lead Platform Architect — Developer Experience 2023 — 2024

H&M Group

- Architected multi-cloud platform backbone achieving 99.9% uptime SLA for 200+ product teams, demonstrating deep Azure Infrastructure and App Services expertise
- Led architecture design sessions for Internal Developer Platform with Azure Functions and EventGrid, creating repeatable IP reducing team onboarding from days to minutes
- Drive technical excellence across Azure AI workloads by evaluating and deploying production-scale AI tools, improving team velocity by 40%
- Collaborated with internal teams to shape architecture reviews and design exercises, establishing reusable patterns for enterprise-wide adoption

Senior Cloud Engineer — Infrastructure & Applications 2020 — 2023

H&M Group

- Designed secure Zero Trust microservices architecture with 15+ Azure Applications achieving sub-100ms p99 latency, demonstrating technical excellence in infrastructure design
- Built high-performance App Services and REST APIs handling 50K+ RPM with automated scaling, showcasing deep Azure workloads optimization expertise
- Accelerated Azure adoption through GitHub standardisation across 200+ repositories with 95% pipeline success rate, resolving technical blockers at enterprise scale

Cloud Solutions Consultant — Enterprise 2019 — 2020

Volvo Cars

- Built trusted relationships as customer-facing technical consultant, designing enterprise observability platform on Azure Kubernetes Service monitoring 100+ microservices
- Owned technical delivery for CI/CD pipeline optimization reducing deployment cycle time from hours to 15 minutes, demonstrating delivery oversight excellence
- Contributed to technical communities through architecture documentation and knowledge sharing, achieving 99.5% SLA compliance across production Azure workloads

Cloud Solution Engineer — Enterprise Delivery 2016 — 2019

Cognizant Technology Solutions

- Owned end-to-end technical delivery for 5+ enterprise customers, designing cloud architectures and CI/CD pipelines aligned to customer success plans
- Built customer-facing App Services including Cloud Management Dashboard providing real-time infrastructure visibility to enterprise stakeholders
- Contributed to technical communities and mentoring through knowledge transfer sessions, building cloud fluency across enterprise customer organizations

KEY SOLUTIONS & ARCHITECTURE PROJECTS

Enterprise AI Platform — Multi-Model Orchestration

Architected production-scale AI platform using Azure AI Foundry serving 200+ teams. Multi-model inference with auto-scaling and A/B evaluation across AWS Bedrock, Azure AI, and Vertex AI.

AML/KYC Serverless Migration — Azure Architecture

Led architecture design sessions for complete cloud migration to Azure serverless. Built LLM-powered autonomous agent using Azure AI reducing delivery time 60%.

Enterprise FinOps Platform — Azure Cost Optimization

Delivered repeatable IP for multi-million SEK cost reduction through Azure workloads optimization. Automated governance and right-sizing across multi-cloud estate.

OpenClaw Tesla — AI Vehicle Agent

Open-source AI agent demonstrating GitHub collaboration and technical communities contribution. 21 voice-controlled actions with OAuth 2.0 integration.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP) — Exam 533: Azure Infrastructure
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- OpenHack: AI-Powered Knowledge Mining · Containers · Security, Compliance & Identity · DevOps
- AWS Certified DevOps Engineer — Professional
- AWS Certified Developer — Associate

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology — Computer Science & Engineering

2012 — 2016

Galgotias University, Greater Noida, India

Specialisation in Cloud Computing & Virtualisation. Projects: IoT Heart Rate Monitor, Big Data Analytics.

PUBLICATIONS & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

I Gave an AI Agent Root Access to a Sandboxed Linux Box — Thought leadership on AI agent experimentation and production-scale AI readiness considerations

Azure DevOps is the new VSTS — Enterprise Azure adoption insights and technical delivery transformation

Building Apps on Google Cloud Run — Cloud architecture patterns and App Services deployment best practices

What is Kubernetes? — Technical communities contribution on Azure Infrastructure and container orchestration

OpenAI & DALL-E Experimentation — AI transformation insights and production-scale AI implementation guidance